

Keyfactor

Cybersecurity · Machine Identity / PKI / Post-Quantum · Independence, Ohio · Private (\$1B+ round, Jul 2026; valuation undisclosed)

Keyfactor, the Ohio machine-identity and PKI company, announced a \$1B+ strategic growth investment led by Summit Partners on 6 July 2026, with Insight Partners and Sixth Street Growth staying in. Private-equity money with a mandate for scale, arriving as post-quantum migration turns its category into a board topic.

80

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

On 6 July Keyfactor announced a \$1B+ strategic growth investment led by Summit Partners; Insight Partners and Sixth Street Growth keep significant stakes and the valuation was not disclosed. It follows \$77M from Insight in 2019, \$125M with the PrimeKey merger in 2021 and a Sixth Street minority round at about \$1.3B in October 2023. The company manages billions of machine identities a year for more than 2,500 customers in 150 countries, over 40% of the Fortune 100 among them, and reached FedRAMP status this year. Stated use of funds: product, expansion, team, acquisitions.

Cybersecurity is a proven Formula 1 category: CrowdStrike at Mercedes, Keeper at Williams, 1Password at Red Bull, Bitdefender at Ferrari, Okta at McLaren and, since November 2025, SEALSQ's post-quantum chips at Alpine. Machine identity, the layer beneath all of them, is not yet on the grid. Keyfactor's automotive practice already issues certificate identities to vehicles and signs their firmware, which is the language a works team owned by a carmaker speaks.

WHY NOW

The round closed on 6 July, and a growth-equity mandate spends its first year on reach. Cadillac's debut season still has Austin in October and Las Vegas in November, and 2027 rosters close in the fourth quarter. Post-quantum migration is now a dated programme in every regulated industry Keyfactor sells to.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$1B+

\$1B+ strategic growth investment led by Summit Partners, announced 6 Jul 2026; Insight Partners and Sixth S...

\$77M

Summit Partners (lead, 2026); Insight Partners (\$77M in Jan 2019 and \$125M with the PrimeKey merger in Apr...

40%

The company manages billions of machine identities a year for more than 2,500 customers in 150 countries, o...

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Cadillac F1 Team ◆ RECOMMENDED	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	TAKEN	CrowdStrike
Atlassian Williams Racing	TAKEN	Keeper
TGR Haas F1 Team	TAKEN	Haas Automation

BOTTOM LINE

A \$1B+ round led by Summit Partners, a category the grid has validated six times over, and a debut American team that lists cybersecurity as an open lane put Keyfactor at peak brand-investment authority with a clean seat available. Two US races remain inside the window.

WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac enters in 2026 with a greenfield technology roster: TWG AI, Core Scientific, IFS, Claro, Tenneco, Tommy Hilfiger and Jim Beam. There is no cybersecurity or identity partner, and the team's own profile lists cybersecurity as an open category. The parent is General Motors, a carmaker, and vehicle and ECU identity is precisely what Keyfactor's automotive practice does. An Ohio company on the American team is a US story for Austin and Las Vegas.

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. A Formula 1 team is a fleet of machines that must trust each other: factory and trackside servers, telemetry links, simulators, supplier connections and the software on the car. Keyfactor automates the certificates behind those connections and signs the code deployed to the car, so a debut team builds its security estate right from day one. In return: partner designation, engineering content and US-race hospitality for banking and federal buyers.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Cybersecurity Partner (machine identity). **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, matching the post-quantum migration window and a probable exit path for Summit. Estimated \$3-5M a year, part in platform services. Scope: endplate or halo placement, naming of the team's trust infrastructure, Austin and Las Vegas hospitality, technical content.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Jordan Rackie
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER, KEYFACTOR · **VERIFIED**

Rackie has led Keyfactor since May 2019, through the PrimeKey merger and three institutional rounds; a first sports partnership is his call. Path: Mike Volanoski, President and Chief Revenue Officer (sales, marketing, channel; since January 2026); Jamie Walker, Chief Marketing Officer; Scott Meyerhoff, CFO.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the category precedent.

“Jordan, six Formula 1 teams already carry a security partner and none carries the machine-identity layer beneath them. Cadillac is the American debut and the lane is open. 25 minutes before Austin to see the numbers?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 17 / 20 Round announced 6 Jul; Austin and Las Vegas inside the window.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$1B+ growth round; 2,500+ customers; valuation undisclosed.	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 Security is a proven F1 category; B2B brand, low consumer pull.	URGENCY 14 / 20 PE scale mandate and post-quantum clock; no hard deadline.	OPS FIT 16 / 20 MODE A: PKI and code signing across the team estate.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

PE MANDATE, NOT A MARKETING PLAN The release commits the \$1B+ to product, expansion, team and acquisitions; no brand line is stated. **Counter:** Frame the entry as demand generation for the US enterprise and federal segments the round targets, with a pipeline goal.

CROWDED CATEGORY ON THE GRID Six teams already carry a security brand; a seventh can read as me-too. **Counter:** Own the machine-identity and post-quantum sub-category with a working deployment, not a logo.

SOURCES — 14 OF 14 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://www.keyfactor.com/about-us/
- https://www.keyfactor.com/press-releases/keyfactor-announces-1b-strategic-growth-investment-led-by-summit-partners-to-expand-leadership-in-securing-the-ai-and-post-quantum-enterprise/
- https://www.keyfactor.com/solutions/automotive-cybersecurity/
- https://www.keyfactor.com/press-releases/keyfactor-announces-significant-minority-investment-from-sixth-street-growth-valuing-the-company-at-approximately-1-3b/